Workshop 4.2: Security, Ethics & Long-term Governance

Phase 4: Digital Sustainability

Workshop Code: WS 4.2
Primary Component: All Components (Integration & Governance)
Duration: 2 days
Timing: Month 11, Week 2-3
Phase Theme: "Scaling, Securing, and Sustaining"

Executive Summary

This capstone workshop consolidates all learnings from the preceding 10 workshops and 11-month implementation into comprehensive, formalized governance frameworks. Participants will finalize policies for security, data protection, ethical AI, interoperability, tech hub operations, and regional cooperation. The workshop establishes the long-term governance structures, compliance mechanisms, and sustainability models that will outlive the project and guide T&T's digital transformation for years to come.

Key Outcome: Comprehensive digital governance framework adopted by government, ensuring security, ethics, and sustainability of all digital transformation initiatives.

Workshop Objectives

1. **Consolidate Governance:** Integrate all component-specific governance into unified framework
2. **Formalize Security Standards:** Adopt comprehensive cybersecurity and data protection policies
3. **Embed Ethical Principles:** Codify AI ethics, digital rights, and inclusion commitments
4. **Establish Accountability:** Create oversight, compliance, and enforcement mechanisms
5. **Ensure Sustainability:** Design funding, operations, and evolution models for long-term success

Target Participants (40-50 people)

Government Leadership & Policy (15-18)

- MPAAI senior leadership (Permanent Secretary)
- All component leads (e-ID, interoperability, data centre)
- National-CSIRT director and senior staff
- Data Protection Authority (or equivalent)
- Legal and compliance officers
- Procurement leadership
- Cabinet Secretary's office representative

MDA Representatives (12-15)

- Senior IT/digital leaders from key MDAs
- Representatives from MDA digital transformation community

Oversight & Advisory (10-12)

- GID Advisory Committee (from WS 1.3)
- Civil society representatives (digital rights, privacy)
- Academic experts (law, ethics, technology policy)
- Private sector representatives (from WS 3.3 partnerships)

International & Expert Resources (8-10)

- EU governance and policy experts
- CAF institutional strengthening specialists
- Cybersecurity experts
- AI ethics specialists
- Regional cooperation specialists

Detailed Agenda

DAY 1: Security, Privacy & Ethics

Morning Session (9:00 AM - 12:30 PM)

Opening (30 min)
- Workshop purpose: From project deliverables to enduring governance
- Recap of 11-month journey (all 11 workshops, all accomplishments)
- Importance of governance for sustainability

Presentation: "Digital Governance Frameworks Globally" (40 min)
- EU examples: GDPR, eIDAS regulation, AI Act, Cybersecurity Act
- Estonia's governance model (distributed but coordinated)
- Singapore's Smart Nation governance
- Key principles: Clear authority, accountability, flexibility, stakeholder involvement

Cybersecurity Governance (90 min)
- **Presentation:** "Comprehensive Cybersecurity Framework" (30 min)
- National cybersecurity strategy alignment
- Information security management (ISO 27001)
- Incident response and business continuity
- Security Operations Center (SOC) model
- Threat intelligence and vulnerability management
- Third-party risk management
- Security awareness and training

- **Workshop:** "T&T Digital Security Governance" (50 min)
- Review draft security policy (compiled from all workshops)
- Roles and responsibilities (National-CSIRT, MPAAI, MDAs, third parties)
- Security standards and controls
- Compliance monitoring and auditing
- Incident reporting and escalation

- Continuous improvement processes

- **Discussion & Refinement** (10 min)

12:30 - 1:30 PM: LUNCH

Afternoon Session (1:30 PM - 5:00 PM)

Data Protection & Privacy Governance (90 min)
- **Presentation:** "Data Protection Regulatory Framework" (30 min)
- T&T data protection legislation status
- GDPR as international standard
- Privacy by design and by default
- Data minimization and purpose limitation
- Consent management
- Data subject rights (access, correction, deletion)
- Cross-border data transfers (eIDAS, adequacy)
- Enforcement and penalties

- **Workshop:** "Data Governance Framework" (50 min)
- Data classification (public, internal, confidential, restricted)
- Data lifecycle management (collection, storage, use, retention, deletion)
- Privacy impact assessments (when required, process)

• Data sharing agreements (intra-government, cross-border, third-party)
• Data protection officer roles
• Citizen rights mechanisms (requests, complaints)

• Compliance monitoring

• **Discussion** (10 min)

AI Ethics & Responsible Innovation (90 min)
- **Presentation:** "Governing AI Responsibly" (25 min)
- EU AI Act framework (risk-based approach)
- Nordic AI ethics principles
- UNESCO AI recommendations
- Algorithmic accountability and transparency
- Bias detection and mitigation
- Human oversight requirements
- Impact assessments for high-risk AI

• **Workshop:** "T&T AI Ethics Policy" (55 min)
• Review AI ethics principles (from WS 3.2)
• Risk classification for government AI use cases
• Requirements for high-risk AI (testing, documentation, human review)
• Prohibited uses (if any)
• Algorithmic impact assessments (mandatory triggers)
• Transparency and explainability standards
• Continuous monitoring and auditing

• Public accountability mechanisms

• **Discussion** (10 min)

Day 1 Synthesis (20 min)
- Integration of security, privacy, and ethics frameworks
- Dependencies and synergies
- Homework: Review draft governance charter

DAY 2: Operational Governance & Sustainability

Morning Session (9:00 AM - 12:30 PM)

Interoperability & Tech Hub Governance (90 min)
- **Presentation:** "Platform Governance Models" (20 min)
- API governance (from WS 2.1)
- Open-source governance (from WS 3.1)
- Third-party access governance (from WS 3.3)

- Change management and version control
- Quality assurance and certification

- **Workshop:** "Operational Governance Structure" (60 min)
- **Governance Bodies:**
  - **Digital Transformation Board** (strategic oversight, senior leadership)
  - **Technical Committee** (architecture, standards, technical decisions)
  - **Security & Compliance Committee** (National-CSIRT led)
  - **GID Advisory Committee** (ongoing from WS 1.3)
  - **Regional Cooperation Committee** (from WS 2.2)

For each body:
- Membership and chair
- Meeting frequency and decision-making
- Responsibilities and authority
- Escalation processes
- Relationship to other bodies

- **Operational Functions:**
  - Platform operations team (NOC/SOC)
  - Tech hub management
  - API catalogue maintenance
  - Community management
  - Training and capacity building

- **Discussion** (10 min)

Regional & International Governance (60 min)
- **Presentation:** "Regional Cooperation Governance" (20 min)
- Regional interoperability governance (from WS 2.2, 2.3)
- Caribbean tech hub network governance (from WS 3.1)
- Cross-border data governance
- Dispute resolution mechanisms

- **Workshop:** "Formalizing Regional Governance" (35 min)
- Review regional MOUs and agreements
- Regional governance committee structure
- Cost sharing and funding models
- Expansion to additional countries (entry criteria and process)

- Knowledge sharing and capacity building

- **Discussion** (5 min)

12:30 - 1:30 PM: LUNCH

Afternoon Session (1:30 PM - 5:00 PM)

Sustainability & Funding Models (75 min)
- **Presentation:** "Financing Digital Government Long-term" (25 min)**
- Operating costs (infrastructure, personnel, programs)
- Funding models:
- Direct government budget allocation
- Cost recovery from MDAs (chargeback models)
- Revenue from third-party services
- Regional country contributions
- Grants and development funding
- Public-private partnerships

- **Workshop:** "T&T Digital Transformation Funding Strategy" (40 min)
- 3-year budget projection
- Revenue and cost recovery strategies
- Value demonstration and ROI for budget justification

- Risk mitigation (budget cuts, economic downturns)

- **Discussion** (10 min)

Continuous Improvement & Evolution (45 min)
- **Presentation:** "Innovation Without Disruption" (15 min)
- Balancing stability with innovation
- Technology refresh cycles
- Pilot-to-production pathways
- Learning from failures
- Stakeholder feedback mechanisms

- **Discussion:** "Future Horizons" (25 min)
- Emerging technologies on the horizon (quantum, edge AI, 6G)
- Climate resilience and sustainability imperatives
- Youth and next-generation engagement
- T&T as global digital government exemplar

Final Governance Charter Consolidation (45 min)
- Review complete draft governance charter (all frameworks integrated)
- Identify any gaps or conflicts
- Finalize for adoption
- Endorsement process and timeline

Commitments & Next Steps (30 min)
- Government leadership commits to:
- Adopting governance framework
- Establishing governance bodies

- Allocating budget for sustainability
- Continuing regional cooperation
- Timeline for formal adoption (Cabinet, legislation if needed)
- Transition from project to operations (Month 12)
- Ongoing reporting and accountability

Workshop Closing (15 min)
- Reflections on 11-month journey
- Recognition of contributions
- Vision for the future
- Workshop evaluation

Key Discussion Questions

Governance Questions

- Who has final authority over the digital infrastructure and platforms?
- How do we balance centralized oversight with agency autonomy?
- What happens when governance bodies disagree?
- How do we ensure governance evolves with technology and context?

Security Questions

- What security standards are mandatory vs. recommended?
- How do we enforce compliance with security requirements?
- What are acceptable vs. unacceptable risks?
- How do we balance security with usability and innovation?

Ethics Questions

- How do we ensure ethical principles aren't just paper commitments?
- Who monitors algorithmic fairness and bias?
- What recourse do citizens have if harmed by AI decisions?
- How transparent should government AI systems be?

Sustainability Questions

- Can digital transformation be financially self-sustaining?
- What is government's ongoing commitment?
- How do we maintain capabilities when project team disperses?
- How do we sustain regional cooperation beyond the project?

Expected Outputs & Deliverables

1. **Comprehensive Digital Governance Charter** including:
2. Cybersecurity framework
3. Data protection and privacy policy
4. AI ethics policy
5. Interoperability governance
6. Tech hub operational governance
7. Regional cooperation governance
8. Governance body structures and mandates
9. Compliance and enforcement mechanisms
10. **3-Year Sustainability Plan** (funding, operations, evolution)
11. **Transition Plan** (from project to operations)
12. **Workshop Report** (Product 3 - final workshop report)
13. **Inputs for Product 6** (Final Project Report): Governance framework as key deliverable

Success Metrics

- Governance charter endorsed by all stakeholders
- Government commits to formal adoption (within 1 month)
- All governance bodies established with members appointed (within 6 weeks)
- Sustainability funding committed in next budget cycle
- 4.5/5+ workshop satisfaction
- Consensus that project is well-positioned for long-term success

Connection to Other Workshops

Consolidates ALL Prior Workshops:
- WS 1.1: e-ID governance
- WS 1.2: Data centre governance
- WS 1.3: GID principles embedded throughout
- WS 2.1: Interoperability governance
- WS 2.2: Regional cooperation governance
- WS 2.3: Pilot governance lessons
- WS 3.1: Open-source and tech hub governance
- WS 3.2: Emerging tech ethics

- WS 3.3: Third-party governance
- WS 3.4 & 4.1: Operational insights from MDA adoption

Final Synthesis Workshop

Links to TOR Requirements

TOR Section 6, Services:
- **Service 7:** "Advise the Executing Unit Coordinator on technical matters and consult on decisions involving local stakeholders, CAF, EU, and national entities."
- **Service 12:** "Support delivery of all services mentioned above are delivered in accordance with the relevant international standards and best practices."

TOR Section 7, Products:
- **Product 3:** Workshop Reports (11th and final)
- **Product 6:** Final Project Report (governance framework is core component)

Cross-Cutting:
This workshop ensures responsible, ethical, secure governance across ALL project components per multiple TOR requirements.

Document Status: Draft
Version: 1.0
Date: September 26, 2026

CRITICAL NOTE: This workshop's outputs define the long-term success or failure of the entire digital transformation initiative. The governance framework must be robust, practical, and politically endorsed at the highest levels. Allocate significant post-workshop effort to formal adoption and implementation.